OBJECTIVES

Grow your nation's S&T by investing in technologies that earn Technology Points (TPs). You "win" by achieving the highest final score, which rewards BOTH:

- **Absolute advantage (number of TPs)**
- **Unspent wealth ("W")**
- **Improvement relative to your starting position ("distance traveled")**

That is, a less technologically advanced state gets credit for making up a lot of ground over the duration of the game. Technologically dominant countries can stagnate.

TECHNOLOGY PATHS

- **L** = Incremental tech (low risk / low reward)
- **M** = Advanced or emerging tech (moderate risk / higher reward)
- **H** = Radical or horizon tech (high risk / high reward)

Only "L" techs are available early in the game, but depending on your choices, M and L techs can be unlocked. You can choose to pursue any combination depending on your beliefs about the best way to win the game.

SEQUENCE & STRUCTURE

The game is simultaneous-move over 5-10 rounds. Each round, teams receive spending points to allocate to different strategies. The per-round budget is based on your country's normalized GDP ("W," for national wealth). The budget is always **2 × W.**[1] Teams decide on a strategy for how they want to allocate the budget each round. Unspent points carry over into the next round, with interest. After all teams have decided on a same-round strategy, dice are rolled to determine whether their allocations succeeded. After enough rounds, a winner is declared.

PATHS TO VICTORY

You can allocate spending points to any of six categories:

1. **SE or TE** – Secondary or Tertiary (ie. university) education quality
2. **BR** – Basic Research effort (public; observed by everyone)
3. **AR (L/M/H)** – Applied Research effort (secret; known only to your country)
4. **SP** – Espionage effort (max 2 targets; observe or steal AR earnings)
5. **Research Security / Immigration Policy** (costs 0 dice to change)

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[1] Allocations normally cost 1 spending point, but some are modified to cost more/less depending on your country's particular strengths/weaknesses. You can keep track of how expensive your allocations are in the budget counter.

Below is a summary of how these categories affect the game:

SE	Improves the national talent pool by boosting human capital (K) among the domestic population. Enhances success rate of BR and AR.
TE	Improves the national talent pool by boosting human capital (K) among domestic population *and* international visitors (if any). Enhances success rate of BR and AR.
BR	Establishes minimum conditions for accessing more advanced AR categories. BR is publicly observed, such that foreign BR boosts your country's BR by a factor of 1/2. In that sense, you can free-ride on other teams' investments. However, tacit knowledge (TK) is only earned by the investing countries.
AR	Primary way of earning Technology Points (TPs). You can invest in any of three different categories. Success rates are determined by category difficulty and random chance. Chances can be improved via investments that generate stronger human capital (K) and tacit knowledge (TK). More advanced AR has a min. BR requirement.
SP	Secondary way of earning Technology Points (TPs). Each round, your country can optionally attempt to spy on up to two foreign technology programs. Successful attempts reveal the history of AR spending by the target country. Critically high rolls *earn* your country *all* TPs in that category since the beginning of the game, minus expenditures in the current round. Critically low rolls fail—and reveal your behavior to all other players.
IM	Determines the magnitude of talent flow. France and the United States begin with "open" immigration (=1) or equivalently low research security. China and Russia begin with "closed' immigration (=0) or high research security. Openness can lead to talent *inflow* (higher K) depending on your GDP (W) and relative university quality (TE). Closure provides a slight defensive bonus against espionage.

COUNTRY PROFILES

Countries are **asymmetric** on purpose. Although richer countries have advantages, none is "best." Each has meaningful tradeoffs and real paths to victory.

COUNTRY	STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES
US	Highest W (budget) Strongest TE starting point	Weak SE starting point / high IM-reliance More vulnerable to espionage
China	Large pop → strong SE scaling Strong SE & TE starting points	Large population makes SE expensive Difficult to capitalize on talent inflow
France	Starts with +4 TK (hybrid model) Improving SE is inexpensive	Lower starting W More vulnerable to espionage
Russia	Starts with +7 TK (Soviet legacy) Late-game disruptive potential	Lowest W Vulnerable to talent outflow